

Course Name: Technical Writing and Communication Skills

Course Code: PC 512

Instructor: Purbasha Das

Autumn 2025

Course Outline

This course introduces first-year M. Tech and PhD students to the basics of technical writing and communication skills that are essential in their professional life in the next 50-60 years. The aim is to make the students understand the importance of effective communication for professional success. A set of guidelines on several important aspects of technical writing as well as presentations will be discussed in this course. Several non-technical and technical writing exercises and slide-based presentations would be carried out for practical training of the students. The students will be encouraged to improve their communication skills by taking part in various group activities which will be organized throughout the semester.

Topics

A tentative list of topics is given below:

1. General guidelines of Technical Communication
2. Basic English grammar - selected topics
3. Developing Reading and Listening Skills
4. Writing and defending a Thesis
5. Publishing Papers in Journals
6. Writing and presenting a Paper in a Conference
7. Guidelines on reviewing and responding to reviews
8. Writing a Proposal
9. Writing a resume or CV and tips on good job interviews
10. Writing a Technical Report
11. Corporate Communications: Memos, Reports, etc.
12. Technical Presentation using slides
13. Poster Presentation techniques
14. Organizing references and developing a bibliography
15. Applying for a Patent
16. Ethics for Technical Communication
17. Using platform-independent public-domain software such as LibreOffice Suite, Markdown, LATEX and Beamer.

Reading Materials

- Handouts in the Google Classroom portal of PC512.
- Several E-books (fiction and non-fiction) in the Google Classroom portal.
- Several papers and technical documents in Google Classroom portal.

Suggested Books:

1. Meenakshi Raman and Sangeeta Sharma, *Technical Communication: Principles and Practice, Third Edition* (Oxford University Press, 2015)
2. M. Ashraf Rizvi, *Effective Technical Communication, Second Edition* (McGraw Hill Education Private Ltd., 2018)
3. Elizabeth Tebeaux and Sam Dragga ed., *The Essentials of Technical Communication* (Oxford University Press, 2021).
4. Seth Lindstromberg ed., *The Standby book: Activities for the language classroom* (Cambridge University Press, 1997)
5. Mario Linvolucris and Paul Davis, *More Grammar Games: Cognitive, Affective and Movement activities for EFL students* (Cambridge University Press, 1995)
6. John Seely, *The Oxford Guide to Effective Writing and Speaking, Third Edition* (Oxford University Press, 2013).

Grading Policy

- In-Sem. Exam 1: 30%
- In-Sem. Exam 2: 30%
- End-Sem. Project: 40%
- If any instance of plagiarism, copying and cheating is detected an “F” would be given as the final grade.

NBA Program and Program-Specific Outcomes

P5 Modern tool usage yes

P6 Eng. and society yes

P8 Ethics yes

P9 Ind. and team work yes

P10 Communication yes

P12 Life-long learning yes

PSO 3 yes